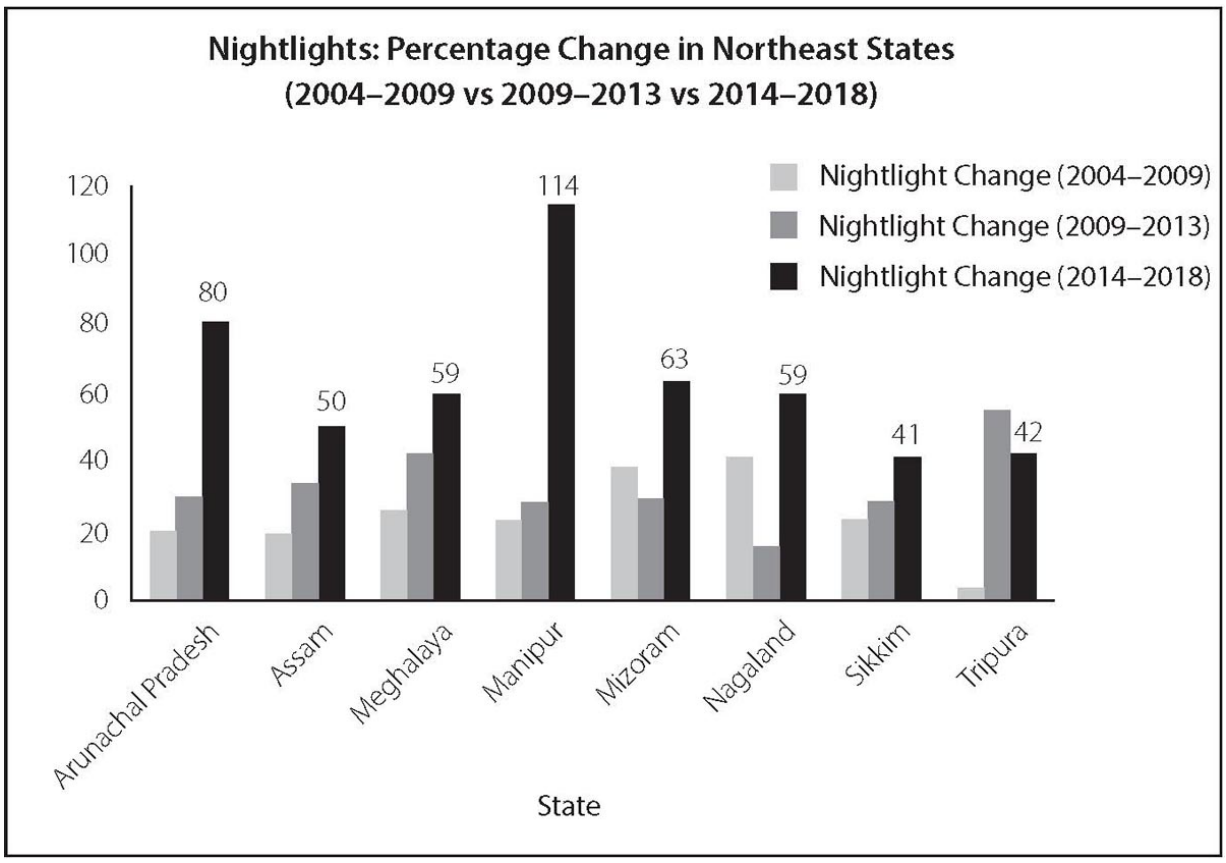


Source: Satellite data extracted from NASA VIIRS Night-time Monthly Lights Composites. (Radiance measured in nanowatts/cm^2/sr.) Data analysis by Rishabh Srivastava, who aggregated data by year, using Python programming, and then mapped it on to all parliamentary constituencies to calculate state-by-state growth.[106]

The role of money and the clout that any Central government wields with its developmental funding is crucial. Narendra Modi indicated as much when he asked Arunachal Pradesh voters to choose 'double-engine growth' (with BJP governments at the Centre and in the state) while addressing a public rally in Aalo in April 2019.[107] This has been a standard BJP slogan in every election since the party came to power in Delhi. Yet, in the Northeast, it has a special resonance because these states are far more dependent on the Central government for funding than most others.

The north-eastern states, like many others, were created on linguistic principles or based on political exigencies. Their tax revenue base, which was not a criterion for their creation, is much lower than the national average. States such as Haryana, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Telangana or Delhi raise about 70